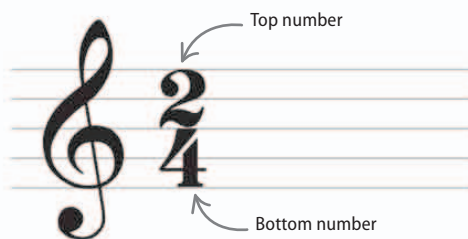


Time signatures

How time signatures work

Time signatures show the number and note value of beats in a measure. The top number of the time signature shows the number of beats, and the bottom number shows the note value of each beat.



◁ Time signature

Time signature 2/4 indicates that there are two quarter-note beats in a measure.

Bottom number	Note value	Note value written out
2	Half note	
4	Quarter note	
8	Eighth note	
16	Sixteenth note	

Simple time signatures

With simple time signatures, the beat is not a dotted note and is subdivided into two. Shown below are some of the most common simple time signatures.



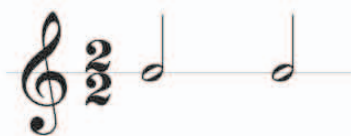
2/4 time signature



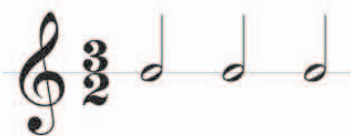
3/4 time signature



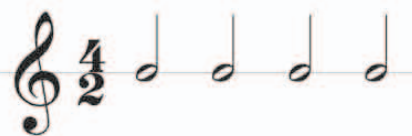
4/4 time signature (also called common time)



2/2 time signature (also called cut time)



3/2 time signature



4/2 time signature



3/8 time signature



3/16 time signature